CLASS 1: SIGNAL TO PROBLEM.

Finding a problem worth solving, and how to use AI to check it.

WHO USED AI TO MAKE A DECISION THIS WEEK?

Did it ever disagree with you?

BLOCK 2 · FIVE CLASSES

DECIDE · BUILD · SELL · OPERATE.

DECIDE	BUILD	SELL	OPERATE
01 SIGNAL TO PROBLEM — TODAY	03 BUILDING IT	04 SELLING AND SCALING WITH ONE OR TWO PEOPLE	05 AI IN OPERATIONS
02 DECIDING WHAT TO BUILD			

Technical depth (models, evals, code) comes in the co-founder's six classes.

WHERE THE EXAMPLES COME FROM

HOW I GOT HERE.



EDUCATION

BUET Civil Engineering
MBA at IBA–DU.

→

PRODUCTS

SaaS built and sold in 60+ countries for over 7 years

→

OPERATIONS

Looking after family business in garment industry

TRACK ONE · PRODUCTS

WHAT WE BUILT AND SOLD.

Agency Handy

Client and project management for small agencies

$200k+

1,000+ agencies, 63 countries

AI: AI and MCP layers in the product

Feedboss

AI LinkedIn content and growth

$150k+

Generated over the last 3 months

AI: Writes our own LinkedIn

Onethread

Project management for teams in Bangladesh

Enterprise clients onboarded

Built before AI: The research that killed it took a year.

Micro SaaS

Small products, built and sold

Several

profitable exits in global market

Built before AI: Each one took months, not weekends.

In development: AgentiSEO · Righted

THE HONEST SCOREBOARD

WHAT DIDN'T WORK, AND WHAT IT TAUGHT ME.

01 **TIGROW** · enterprise connectivity, launched 2020 at peak covid

> **Timing matters as much as the product.**

02 **ONETHREAD** · the global plan stalled, pivoted to the local market

> **A market you can't reach isn't your market.**

03 **RIGHTED** · AI said the market was empty. It wasn't. Parked.

> **Check AI's work before you build.**

04 **FACTORY CATEGORIES** · pet accessories and travel goods, killed before we spent money

> **Filter first, spend later.**

HANDS UP IF YOU HAVE A PRODUCT IDEA.



SECTION 02

GETTING A REAL ANSWER OUT OF AI

02

THE ONLY VARIABLE THAT CHANGED

LIVE

SAME MODEL. DIFFERENT CONTEXT.

WITHOUT CONTEXT

Is an AI tool for small restaurants in Dhaka a good idea?

WITH CONTEXT

I'm a third-year CSE student at IUT. I can build web apps, I have 15 hours a week and no money to spend. My uncle runs two restaurants in Dhanmondi. I want side income within a year. Is an AI tool for small restaurants in Dhaka a good idea for me, and what should I check first?

TWO MODES, AND YOU PICK

IT ANSWERS FROM MEMORY UNLESS YOU STOP IT.

MODE ONE

FROM MEMORY

Instant, and free

Stops at a training cutoff

No sources, ever

With nothing specific to go on, you get the average of every startup article ever written.

MODE TWO

WITH SEARCH

Slower, and costs calls

Current

But only finds what ranks

> **No sources in the answer means no research happened.**

FORCE IT TO GO AND LOOK.

01	**Ask it to search, explicitly**	“search the web” is not implied by the question
02	**Demand sources, then open them**	if you would not click it, do not cite it
03	**Make it quote the sentence**	not the page, not the domain
04	**Use deep research modes**	when the question is worth ten minutes of its time

RULE **Cited does not mean read.**

THE REACH OF ANY MODEL

WHAT IT WON'T GO AND GET.

IT WILL FIND

Public reviews

App stores

Job posts

Ad libraries

Search data

Company registries

IT WILL MISS

Anything behind a login

Private groups and DMs

WhatsApp, where half the trade happens

Most Bangla-language discussion

What your uncle says at the counter

WATCH FOR **Some of the right column has an official API, if you have access. None of it is in the answer by default.**

CLOSING THE GAP YOURSELF

CARRY THE DATA IN BY HAND.



PASTE EXPORTS AND CHAT LOGS

WhatsApp threads, order sheets, the group nobody indexes.



UPLOAD SCREENSHOTS

What you saw on the counter, in the app, on the shelf.



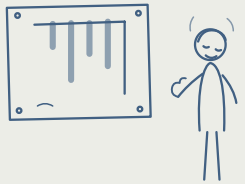
WRITE UP YOUR OWN VISITS

Site visits and interviews, in your words, with dates.

RULE **Private context is the only edge you have. Nobody else's model has it.**

FOUR WAYS AI FAILS YOU

IT WILL NOT PUSH BACK.



01	It agrees with you	“Should I build this?” →	“Great idea!”
02	It invents facts	“Quote for 5,000 polo shirts?” →	a confident number, 30% below cost
03	It fills gaps quietly	“Summarise these 50 reviews” →	three complaints that were never there
04	It writes like nobody you know	“Write a sales email” →	“Dear Valued Customer…”

WATCH FOR **All four come from the same thing: it knows nothing about you, and it didn't go and look.**

WHY IT AGREES WITH YOU

AGREEMENT IS TRAINED IN.

Models are tuned on human ratings, and people rate agreement highly.

Ask if your plan is good and you get encouragement by construction.

A role with a stake beats asking for feedback.

ACT AS A SKEPTICAL INVESTOR

“Who else has tried this and quit?”

ACT AS A COMPETITOR WHO WANTS THIS MARKET

“I would undercut you in a month. Then what?”

ACT AS A BUYER WHO HAS BEEN BURNED

“The last one promised this too. Why is yours different?”

IT KNOWS NOTHING ABOUT YOU.

TAKE AN IDEA YOU'VE HAD.

What would AI need to know about you to judge it?

SECTION 03

YOUR CONTEXT

03

HOW TO WRITE IT

CONTEXT IS A STRUCTURE, NOT A PARAGRAPH.

01	**Who you are**	and what you can actually build
02	**What you have access to**	people, businesses, rooms, data
03	**What you want out of this**	the outcome, in one sentence
04	**What you will not do**	the constraints that are real
05	**Then the question**	last, and only last

Put the question last. Everything before it shapes the answer.

WHERE IT LIVES

THREE PLACES TO KEEP IT.

PROJECT KNOWLEDGE, OR A CUSTOM GPT

it travels with every chat in that project

A FILE YOU RE-UPLOAD

works in any model, and you control the version

CUSTOM INSTRUCTIONS

only for the things that never change

THE FAILURE MODE

A long chat drifts. By message 40 it is contradicting decisions you made at message 5.

THE HABIT

A fresh chat plus your doc beats a long thread, every time.

RULE **Write it once. Paste it everywhere.**

YOUR REALITY

SEVEN THINGS ONLY YOU KNOW.

SKILLS
what you can actually build today

ACCESS
rooms and businesses you can walk into

PEOPLE
who will answer your call

TIME
hours a week, honestly counted

MONEY
what you can lose without pain

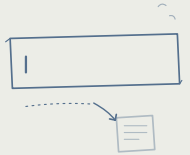
TOOLS
what you already pay for

REACH
anyone who already listens to you



WATCH FOR **Access. A family business is a market you can see and others can't.**

TRY THIS PROMPT



Interview me one question at a time to build my founder context: skills, access, people, time, money, tools and reach, then the outcome I want. Push back when my answers are vague. At the end, write it as a one-page context doc.

YOUR OUTCOME

THREE DIFFERENT GAMES.

SIDE INCOME

DEMANDS

10 to 15 hours a week, no outside money

SUCCESS IS

a few hundred dollars a month that keeps arriving

BILLING TOOL, TWO RESTAURANTS

A good fit. Two paying customers you can reach this week.

SUSTAINABLE BUSINESS

DEMANDS

full attention, a small team, years

SUCCESS IS

a business that pays salaries without you selling every day

BILLING TOOL, TWO RESTAURANTS

Maybe. You would need a hundred of them.

VENTURE SCALE

DEMANDS

investors, a co-founder, a market big enough to justify both

SUCCESS IS

a company someone would pay a lot to own

BILLING TOOL, TWO RESTAURANTS

No. The market is too small to justify the money.

Nothing about the idea changed. Only the yardstick.

DECIDE THE CRITERIA FIRST

WRITE THE FILTER BEFORE YOU LOOK.

THE FACTORY FILTER

01 Can we make it?

02 Is demand real and growing?

03 Is it underserved?

04 Can we reach the buyers?

05 Can we sell to them in English, from Dhaka?

Give AI the filter and ten candidates. Make it answer all five per candidate and show its reasoning. **Never ask it which idea is best.**

DIED HERE **Pet accessories and travel goods, both of them.**

SAY YOUR OUTCOME IN ONE SENTENCE.

Your partner asks: is your reality enough for that?

SECTION 04

GETTING REAL DATA IN

04

REVIEWS ARE A DATASET, NOT READING

FOUR STEPS, IN ORDER.

01
PULL
export them, all of them

→

02
EXTRACT
problem, quote, frequency, workaround

→

03
CLUSTER
by underlying cause, not by wording

→

04
COUNT
each cluster, then rank

RULE **The clustering step, not the reading step.**

WHERE THE DATA ACTUALLY LIVES

EIGHT SOURCES WORTH KNOWING.

App Store and Play Store
API OR PROVIDER

complaints about tools people already pay for

Meta Ad Library
FREE

ads still running are ads that work

Job boards
FREE

a salary paid to do it by hand

Google Trends
FREE

direction, not volume

Google Places
PAID PAST CREDIT

small businesses, ratings, what customers say

Company registries
FREE

who exists, how big, how new

Reddit and forums
FREE

the same complaint, posted again

SEO and SERP providers
PAID

keyword volume and difficulty at scale

Check current terms and pricing before you build on any of them.

WHAT NOT TO POINT A SCRAPER AT

THESE WILL BLOCK YOU.

- ✕ LinkedIn
- ✕ Amazon
- ✕ Facebook and Instagram
- ✕ Google search results
- ✕ Glassdoor

DO THIS INSTEAD

01 Use the official API

or a licensed data provider

02 Never your main account

make a separate one, expect to lose it

03 Export by hand

when it is 50 rows and not 50,000

WATCH FOR A banned account mid-research costs you more than the data was worth.

YOUR SECOND ARTIFACT

THE PROBLEM SHEET.

ILLUSTRATIVE ROWS

WHO	WHAT THEY SAID	WHERE	PAYING TODAY?
Garment accounts clerk	“I check 400 lines against POs every single day”	Site visit, Mar	**Yes, a salary**
Agency owner, 6 staff	“we lost a client because nobody chased the approval”	Facebook group	**Yes, a VA**
Clinic manager	“the appointment book is a WhatsApp thread”	Interview	**No**
Freight forwarder	“three people retype the same shipment details all day”	Site visit, Apr	**Yes, three salaries**

01 · every row carries the quote it came from. No quote, no row.

HOW THE WORK GETS DONE

FOUR WAYS TO DO ANY TASK.

01

BUY

A SaaS tool that already does it.

02

CHAT

You, a good prompt, and your context.

03

AUTOMATE

A workflow calling model APIs on a schedule.

04

AGENT

Runs on its own, checks its own work.

What decides: time · money · technical skill · how often it repeats.

RULE **Same task, four prices. Pick the cheapest one that works.**

CHAT · FIRST

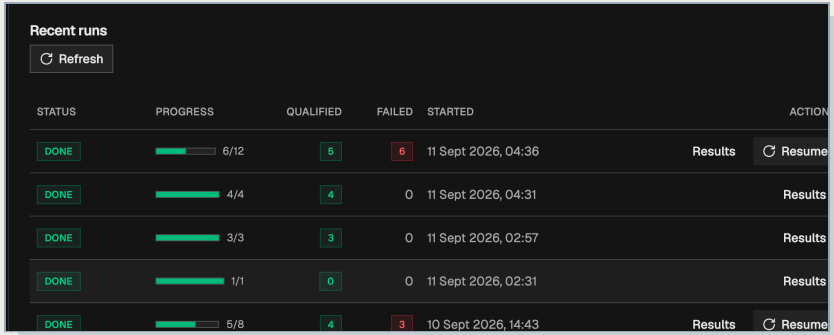
READ 50 YOURSELF.

By hand, with a notebook. You are looking for what the categories even are.

You can't write the extraction rules until you've seen what's in there.

AUTOMATE · THEN

AUTOMATE THE NEXT 5,000.



01 · the scheduled pipeline, running overnight

AI writes the pull script. You decide what gets pulled, and you read the first 50.

SURVIVORSHIP, IN YOUR DATA

WHO NEVER SHOWS UP IN YOUR DATA.

REVIEWS	come from the angry and the delighted. Nobody in the middle writes one.
JOB POSTS	come from companies that can afford to hire. Most cannot.
THE PERSON DOING IT BY HAND	writes nothing, anywhere, ever.

In Dhaka, that last one is most of your market. Go and look in person.

A SMALL PROBLEM PEOPLE PAY FOR TODAY?

Or a big one nobody pays for yet?

SECTION 05

CHECKING AI'S WORK

05

WHY AI REPORTS EMPTY MARKETS

THREE REASONS IT SAYS NOBODY IS THERE.

01 THIN COVERAGE

small and non-English categories are barely written about in the training data

02 A TRAINING CUTOFF

anything launched recently simply is not in there

03 SEARCH THAT RANKS

it surfaces whatever ranks well, which is whoever does SEO, not whoever competes

WATCH FOR **Absence of evidence, reported as evidence of absence.**

WHAT AI SAID

> “There is no established player doing this. The space looks open.”

One model. One question. No sources.

WHAT WAS TRUE

SEVERAL FUNDED PLAYERS, ALL MAKING THE SAME CLAIM.

A second model with web search found them in one pass.

Parked before launch. Cheap lesson.

LIVE

THE CROSS-CHECK.

01 **Ask two or three models**
the identical question, worded the same way

02 **Force search, and open the citations**

03 **Chase every disagreement**
where they differ is where the truth usually is

04 **Follow ads and hiring**
not product lists, which are mostly old

MODEL A

"Around 40 digital agencies in Bangladesh use retainer tooling. The market is too small to build for."

VERDICT: NOT WORTH IT

MODEL B

"No reliable count exists. 300+ Bangladeshi agencies are hiring project managers on Upwork right now."

VERDICT: DATA MISSING, DEMAND VISIBLE

WATCH FOR **Every place they disagree is something you have to check yourself.**

BEFORE NEXT CLASS

THREE THINGS.

01

FINISH THE CONTEXT DOC

Your reality, your outcome, the decisions you made and the ones still open.

02

START THE PROBLEM SHEET

Twenty rows of evidence. Every row carries the quote it came from.

03

LIST FIVE COMPETITORS

Save their pricing pages. We open them in Class 2.

NEXT CLASS: WHAT EXACTLY TO BUILD.